

August 13, 2026

UnitedHealthcare
Provider Appeals
P.O. Box 30432
Salt Lake City, UT 84130

RE: Formal Appeal of Claim Denial — Jenee Turcotte (MRN MUSC0686121), Claim MUSC-CC97-1

Patient	Jenee Turcotte (DOB 1979-12-30)
MRN	MUSC0686121
Member ID / Group	UHC683527916 / GRP-16096
Claim number	MUSC-CC97-1
Date of service	2026-03-02
Procedure billed	CPT 99214 — Office/outpatient visit, established patient, moderate complexity
Primary diagnosis	E66.9 — Obesity, unspecified
Denied amount	\$492.45
Denial code	CARC 50 / RARC N115 — These are non-covered services because this is not deemed a 'medical necessity' by the payer.
Appeal deadline	2027-03-20

Dear Appeals Review Committee:

SUMMARY OF APPEAL

MUSC Health is submitting this formal first-level appeal on behalf of patient Jenee Turcotte (MRN: MUSC0686121, Member ID: UHC683527916, Group: GRP-16096) regarding the denial of Claim MUSC-CC97-1 for services rendered on March 2, 2026, at MUSC Health Florence Medical Center. UnitedHealthcare denied the claim under CARC 50 ("These are non-covered services because this is not deemed a 'medical necessity' by the payer") and RARC N115 ("This decision was based on a Local Coverage Determination (LCD)"), with the accompanying remark that "Documentation submitted does not establish that the service was reasonable and necessary for the diagnosis reported." MUSC Health respectfully disagrees with this determination and requests full reversal and payment at the allowed amount of \$307.21.

CLINICAL BACKGROUND

Ms. Turcotte is a 46-year-old female with an established, active diagnosis of obesity (E66.9), documented as ongoing since May 2015, and a longstanding history of hypertension (I10), active since 1998 and currently managed with hydrochlorothiazide 25 mg. She presented on March 2, 2026, as an established outpatient patient to Dr. Elena V. Castellanos, MD (NPI 1881726354) at MUSC Health Florence Medical Center, an on-campus outpatient hospital facility (Place of Service 22). The visit was billed as CPT 99214, an office or outpatient visit for an established patient requiring moderate-complexity medical decision-making, with a primary diagnosis of E66.9 and a secondary diagnosis of J06.9.

BASIS FOR APPEAL

The denial of this claim as not medically necessary is not supported by the clinical facts of record. Obesity (E66.9) is a chronic, progressive disease with well-established associations with serious comorbid conditions. Ms. Turcotte carries an active diagnosis of hypertension managed with ongoing pharmacotherapy, a condition directly compounded by obesity. The co-occurrence of these two active, chronic conditions in a 46-year-old patient creates a clinical picture that unambiguously warrants regular physician evaluation and management. A level-4 established patient visit (CPT 99214) is consistent with the moderate complexity inherent in managing a patient with multiple active chronic conditions requiring ongoing assessment, medication management, and risk stratification.

The selection of CPT 99214 is appropriate under current Evaluation and Management coding guidelines, which base level selection on medical decision-making complexity or total time. Managing two interrelated chronic conditions — obesity and hypertension — in a single encounter supports a moderate-complexity determination. The claim was submitted correctly with supporting diagnoses, and the rendering provider's documentation should reflect the clinical rationale for the visit level selected. If UnitedHealthcare's review was conducted without access to the complete encounter documentation, MUSC Health respectfully requests that a clinical reviewer re-evaluate the record in its entirety prior to issuing a final determination.

Furthermore, to the extent this denial relies on a Local Coverage Determination, MUSC Health notes that LCDs govern Medicare coverage policy and are not directly applicable to commercial PPO claims. Applying an LCD framework to a commercially insured member's claim without a corresponding contractual basis would be inconsistent with the terms of the parties' agreement and with generally accepted standards for commercial claims adjudication.

REQUESTED ACTION

MUSC Health respectfully requests that UnitedHealthcare conduct a full clinical review of this appeal, including all submitted encounter documentation, and reverse the denial of Claim MUSC-CC97-1. We request that payment be issued at the contractually allowed amount of \$307.21 for CPT 99214 rendered on March 2, 2026. Should UnitedHealthcare require additional clinical documentation to support this appeal, please contact MUSC Health's Revenue Cycle Appeals team promptly so that records may be provided within the applicable timeframe. We ask that this appeal be resolved in accordance with UnitedHealthcare's prompt-pay and appeal-response obligations under applicable state and federal requirements.

Respectfully submitted,

Angela R. Whitfield, RN, BSN, CPC

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Enclosures

- Remittance advice / explanation of payment
- Itemized claim detail (UB-04 / CMS-1500)
- Relevant clinical documentation from the medical record